

What a video business coach actually does

A video business coach works on the business around the craft: where the work comes from, how it's sold and priced, how it's delivered without the owner in every seat, the numbers, the team, and how the owner sees their own role. Good coaching finds the one constraint holding the business where it is, agrees one move at a time, and follows up on it. It doesn't do the work for you, and it can't promise a 30-day fix.

What does a video business coach work on?

A video business coach works on the seven systems every production company runs on, whether or not the owner has built them on purpose: marketing, sales, delivery, finance, team, technology and the owner's own mindset.

Most owners are skilled at the craft and self-taught at everything else. Clients don't care about gear, codecs or creative vision. They care about results, budget and timelines, and the coaching covers the part of the company that has to answer to those three things.

- **Marketing** should bring in predictable demand. It usually fails by relying on referrals and word of mouth.
- **Sales** should turn leads into work with clarity. It usually fails by pitching rather than diagnosing.
- **Delivery** should produce consistent work without chaos. It usually fails because everything depends on the founder.
- **Finance** should support decisions with data. It usually fails by tracking revenue, not margin or daily rate.
- **Team** should move the owner from operator to orchestrator. It usually fails by delegating without documenting.

- **Technology** should automate and connect the admin. It usually fails as tool clutter, with tools that don't connect.
- **Mindset** is the owner's own operating system. It usually fails as an operator identity rather than a CEO identity.

The weakest of the seven is usually the one holding the business in place. Finding it is the coach's first job, and it comes before any advice.

What happens in coaching, week to week?

Week-to-week coaching follows a simple loop: diagnose where the business actually is, agree the one move that matters next, do it between sessions, and report back on what happened.

1. **Diagnosis before direction.** A coach looks at your numbers and how the business actually runs, not only how you describe it. Owners often rate their business a step further along than it is, so the evidence matters more than the self-assessment.
2. **One move at a time.** You should leave a session with one clear next action and the reason for it, not a ten-item list. Simplify first, systemise second, and never build complex systems on top of chaos.
3. **Options with their costs, and the choice stays with you.** On the bigger decisions, a good coach lays out two or three different routes, each with its downside, and leaves the call with you. You know your market and your appetite for risk better than anyone outside the business.
4. **Sequencing when you want to jump ahead.** Hiring before the delivery process is written down, or automating before you know what to automate, is a common pull. The instinct is usually right and the timing wrong, so a coach explains the order rather than just saying no.
5. **Follow-up on what you said you'd do.** Commitments get written down and asked about. Much of the value is someone noticing the thing you said you'd do three weeks ago and didn't.

What doesn't a video business coach do?

A video business coach doesn't do the work for you, doesn't trade in motivation, and can't guarantee a result or a timeline.

- **Motivation isn't the deliverable.** If the main thing you leave a session with is energy, nothing in the business has changed yet.
- **A course library isn't coaching.** Information is easy to get. Tactics decay, while a change in how you see your own role persists, and that's the slower work coaching is for.
- **The coach doesn't run your business.** The work between sessions is yours. Coaching that does it for you leaves a business that depends on someone other than its owner.
- **No business is fundamentally reshaped in 30 days.** What 30 days can do is rebuild the foundation. Real deployment, real systems and the growth that follows take 9 to 18 months.
- **Video marketing coaching is a different job.** A video marketing coach teaches businesses to use video in their own marketing. A video business coach works with the owners of video production companies on the company itself: pricing, sales, delivery, team, margin and the owner's role in it.

How do you get the most from a first conversation with a coach?

A first conversation with a coach goes further when you send a short written brief on the business beforehand, so the time goes on diagnosis rather than background.

Copy and paste: a one-page brief to send any coach before a first conversation

The business: [what we make, and for whom], trading for [years]. Team: [who does what, employed or freelance].

Revenue over the last 12 months: [\$]. Margin, if I know it: [%, or "I don't know"].

Where the work comes from: [referrals, repeat clients, outreach, content, platforms].

The problem that keeps coming back: [one sentence].

What I've already tried: [courses, hires, tools, previous coaching]. One thing I changed because of it: [one thing].

If nothing changes in the next 12 months, it costs me: [hours, money, health, family]. It has to be different by: [date].

What I want the business to give me back: [time, income, a month off, a sale one day].

If you can't fill in the line about what you changed because of earlier advice, write that down too. A coach will want to know, and so should you before you pay for more advice.

Who the VBA Elite Boardroom isn't for

The VBA Elite Boardroom isn't for owners still getting their first steady work in the door, or for anyone who wants a coach to do the work for them.

The working baseline is around \$150K a year in revenue, and that's the baseline, not the test. Past it, the test is behaviour: doing the work between calls, acting within days rather than weeks, and taking a challenge without needing to win the argument. Below it, the free [Field Guides](#) cover the early fundamentals, and [when a production company is ready for a coach](#) goes through the signs.

How the VBA Elite Boardroom does it

The VBA Elite Boardroom is Den Lennie's one programme: a weekly group coaching call, Den on Signal between calls, a community of owners held to a written code of conduct, and a proprietary AI toolset built for video production companies.

The coaching runs on [the S.C.A.L.E. Method](#), and it's \$1,700 USD a month, flat, with no onboarding fee, no minimum term and no refunds. Month one is the fit test, for both sides. For the fuller picture, see [what working with a video business coach looks like](#).

Related tools and guides. [Questions to ask a video business coach before you hire them](#), [How to choose a coach for your video production company](#), [When a video production company is ready for a coach](#), [What is the S.C.A.L.E. Method?](#), [Why knowing your numbers lets you price with confidence](#).



The field guides show you how the system works. The Boardroom is where I look at your business with you, give you perspective and judgement on what to do next, and hold you to it every week.

Last reviewed 8 October 2026. denlennie.com